

Draft - expert review pending

This unit is complete and passes the platform's automated checks, but no reviewer has read it yet. Treat its sources and claims with care.

Draft translation - not yet human-reviewed / مسوده ترجمه

Human Growth and Development

Unit 1 ended with a promise: psychology gives a teacher better questions than the staff room supplies. This unit collects the first set of those questions. A Class 2 pupil who cannot compose a sentence, a Class 7 pupil who cannot sit still after lunch, a Class 5 pupil who cries at a wrong answer: each of these is usually read as a behaviour problem or an ability fact. Development offers a third reading - a description of where the pupil is on a long road that every human travels, in an order that is largely fixed and at a speed that is almost entirely individual.

That third reading changes what a teacher does next. It replaces "why is this pupil not like the others?" with "where is this pupil, and what is the next step from there?" This unit works through that shift in four topics.

Unit learning outcomes

By the end of this unit you should be able to:

- Define **development** and distinguish it from growth, maturation and learning.
- State the main **principles** of development - continuous yet stage-like, orderly in sequence, uneven in rate - and use them to read a real classroom observation.
- Explain how **heredity and environment** work together as joint drivers rather than competitors.

- Describe **physical development** through childhood and adolescence, and say what each phase does and does not mean for seating, safety, sport and school work.
- Describe the **cognitive, emotional and social** domains of development and give a classroom sign of each.
- Read a pupil's work or behaviour against a **developmental stage** description, and justify a teaching choice as matched to that stage.

Prerequisite knowledge

Unit 1 (the three-part scope; evidence over proverbs). No biology beyond HSC is assumed. What you do bring, again, is your own schooling: you have lived through every stage this unit describes, and several topics will ask you to remember it.

In this unit

1. Topic 2.1 - What development is, and the principles it follows
2. Topic 2.2 - Physical development
3. Topic 2.3 - Cognitive, emotional and social development
4. Topic 2.4 - Developmental stages and the classroom

How to use this unit

- **Work through the topics in order.** Topic 2.3 uses the principles from 2.1, and Topic 2.4 assembles everything into the stage reading a teacher actually uses.
- **Keep a named pupil in mind.** Each topic asks you to apply its idea to one real pupil you have taught or been. The unit assessment will ask you to do this in writing, so the notes you keep now are worth having.
- **Do not skip the activities.** The drawing comparison in 2.1 and the video task in 2.3 are where the principles stop being words.
- After the four topics, the **unit assessment** page carries a full question bank with answers and marking guidance.

Tip: select any text on this page first to comment on that specific passage - or leave nothing selected for general feedback.

[Give feedback](#)